Model B: Automation-First Operating Model

Oct 8, 2026 · @Kamil Salameh

Summary

Model B runs the US Gateway Desk with **3 people instead of 7**. It does that by having Lebanon deliver every Gateway action as a ready-to-submit bundle, which a US operator checks and files in about 10 minutes instead of 47. It is riskier than Model A because it depends on new software, a much smaller US team, and a tighter daily cycle. In return it saves roughly **$154,000–177,000 a year** today and about **$0.45–0.55 million a year** by year two.

The four bold moves:

1. **A US Submission Cockpit replaces manual typing.** A US operator opens a bundle on a US company device. A helper tool fills the Gateway forms from the bundle while the operator watches. The operator checks every field and clicks submit personally.
2. **Lebanon becomes a "dispute factory".** AI drafts each packet, medical-necessity report and offer letter, and specialists review and approve the drafts. The target is 0.33 specialists per daily visit instead of 0.45.
3. **An Automation Cell of 2 Automation Analysts, both from current specialists,** owns the bundle templates and the AI prompts. The bridge night rota runs the quality gate.
4. **The US desk runs 12 hours a day.** Three staggered US shifts cover 7:00–19:00 Central time, so work prepared in Lebanon is filed the same day.

The one idea we are not building is the mirror bot, which would replay Lebanese actions onto a US PC. It would let offshore staff operate the Gateway through a US machine. That defeats the onshore rule and puts our Gateway access at risk (see Compliance guardrails). The Cockpit reaches the same 3-person target with a US person genuinely doing the work.

Recommendation: Go live on January 1 with Model A's US desk, hired in-house on short contracts. Build the Cockpit in parallel and pilot it in February. Step down to 3 people only after the gates in Rollout are met. If they aren't, we stay on Model A at no extra cost.

Update: the proposal is now Model C, the guided copy desk. Lebanon prepares each dispute in the IDR Prep Studio, which mirrors the Gateway page by page and validates every field. A 5-person US desk copies each field into the Gateway with one-click copy

buttons and submits personally; no tool touches the Gateway. It targets 15 minutes per dispute, is ready for January 1, and needs no Gateway approval beyond the onshore rule. It saves $94,000–114,000 a year today and $328,000–400,000 by year two against Model A, about 60–75% of Model B's saving. Model B remains the long-term option once the Gateway confirms in writing that assisted form filling is allowed.

Ideas we weighed

We tested eight unconventional ideas. Five are in the model, one needs a check against the Gateway's terms first, and two are rejected.

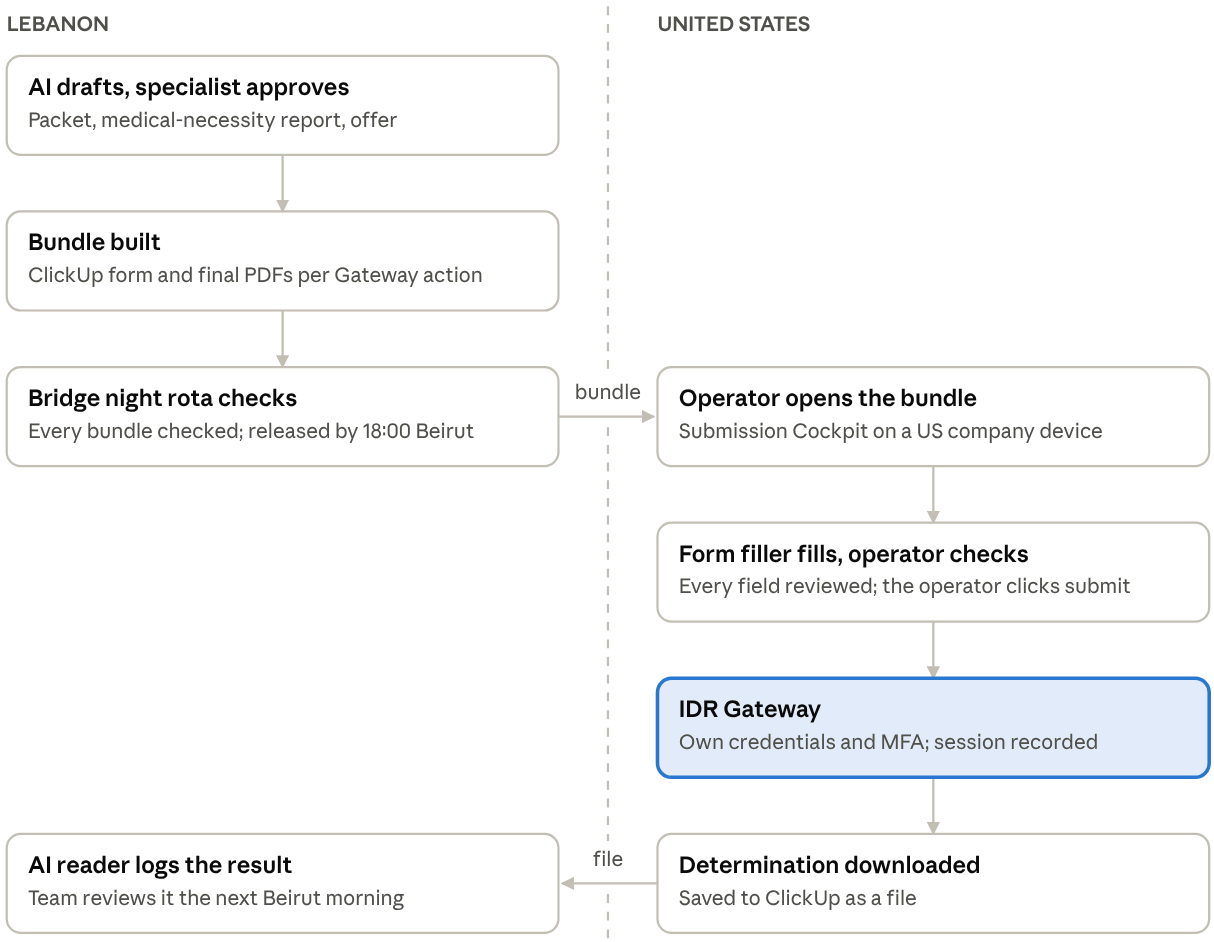
Idea	Verdict	Why
Mirror bot: Lebanese actions replayed on a US PC	**Rejected**	Offshore staff would be operating the Gateway through a proxy, which is the access the rule removes
Fully automatic submission, with no person clicking submit	**Only if the Gateway's terms allow it**	Fastest option, but most portals ban unattended bots; it needs written confirmation first
Operator-run form filling (the Cockpit)	**In**	A US person runs every session and checks every field; the tool only removes typing
Gateway bulk upload for batched items	**In, if available**	Cuts the work on large batches the most
AI dispute factory in Lebanon	**In**	AI drafts packets, reports and offers; specialists approve
AI reading of determinations	**In**	Outcomes are logged automatically in ClickUp overnight
Three staggered US shifts	**In**	12 hours of filing a day with 3 people
US gig marketplace for data entry	**Rejected**	Health data (PHI), training and control risks are too high

How it works

Lebanon prepares everything, and a US operator files it. Only files cross between the two sides.

Only files cross to the US; a US operator files every action

The dashed line is the boundary: no Gateway screen or remote control ever crosses it.



Model B flow · Lebanon prepares, the US files

The time saving comes from the bundle: the operator no longer types, looks things up or chooses anything. Their job is to check and submit, which brings filing time down from about 47 minutes per dispute to a target of 10.

Compliance guardrails

Only a US-based person, on a US company device, ever sees or acts in the Gateway. Lebanon prepares the work and never touches a Gateway session, directly or remotely.

Always	Never
A named US operator signs in with their own credentials and MFA	Shared logins, or credentials kept on a server
The operator reviews every field and clicks submit personally	Unattended submission, unless the Gateway's operator confirms in writing that it's allowed
Lebanon delivers bundles; the US sends results back as files	Screen sharing, remote control or mirroring of a Gateway session to Lebanon
Every session is logged and screen-recorded on the US device	Offshore staff seeing live Gateway screens
HIPAA BAAs with every vendor that holds PHI	PHI in any tool without a BAA

Before we build: we get written legal sign-off on the Cockpit design, and written confirmation that the Gateway's terms allow assisted form filling. If either answer is no, the Cockpit is limited to on-screen copy assistance and the desk stays at Model A's size.

Structure

The 10 managers and 10 teams stay as in Model A. Two changes: 2 current specialists form an Automation Cell, and the US desk shrinks to 3.

Unit	People	Reports to	Owns
Full-cycle teams (10)	10 managers, 10 team leads, 70 RCM specialists	Head of ER OON Revenue Cycle	Accounts from coding to final payment; reviewing and approving the AI drafts
Automation Cell	2 Automation Analysts (from current specialists)	Submission program manager (one of the 10 managers)	Bundle templates, AI prompts, ClickUp automations

Unit	People	Reports to	Owns
Bridge night rota (Bundle QA)	2 members a night from an opt-in rota of L2–L4 holding B2; at least one A2 holder each night	Onshore–Offshore Liaison portfolio owner	The final check before a bundle goes to the US; answering the US desk
US Submission Desk	1 Submission Lead, 2 Submission Specialists	Head of ER OON Revenue Cycle	Filing every Gateway action from a bundle; sending results back
QA department (existing)	No change	No change	Audits, including a monthly review of Cockpit session recordings

Headcount: Lebanon headcount is the same as in Model A. The 2 Automation Analysts come from current specialists, and the bridge night rota is staffed by existing members who opt in. The US desk is 3 instead of Model A's 7.

Growth: with AI drafting, the target is 0.33 specialists per daily visit:

- About 102 specialists by year two instead of 125, roughly 23 fewer hires.
- The US desk grows to about 5 people in year one and 7 in year two, instead of 12 and 18.

Job descriptions

Four roles are new or changed; every other role is as in Model A.

US Submission Lead (1)

Purpose: Owns same-day filing and Gateway compliance in the US.

- **Duties:**
  - Files bundles about half the time.
  - Assigns the queue and plans coverage.
  - Manages credentials, MFA and quarterly access reviews.
  - Audits a daily sample of session recordings.
  - Escalates Gateway problems.

- **Requirements:** 3+ years in healthcare revenue cycle or payer portals; NSA/IDR experience preferred; HIPAA-trained; based in the US.
- **KPIs:**
  - 100% of bundles received by the cutoff filed the same day.
  - Zero filing errors reach the Gateway.
  - Backlog under 1 business day.

US Submission Specialist (2)

Purpose: Files Gateway actions from bundles, accurately and on the same day.

- **Duties:**
  - Works the Cockpit queue during the shift.
  - Checks every filled field against the bundle checklist, then submits.
  - Records fees.
  - Downloads determinations and correspondence.
  - Returns any mismatch to Bundle QA within 15 minutes.
- **Requirements:** 1–2 years of healthcare or insurance data entry; pass a 99% accuracy test; HIPAA-trained; based in the US.
- **KPIs:**
  - About 40 disputes' worth of actions per shift.
  - Error rate under 0.5%.
  - Same-day completion.

Automation Analyst, Lebanon (2)

Purpose: Keeps bundles and AI drafts accurate and fast.

- **Duties:**
  - Maintains a bundle template for each Gateway action.
  - Keeps the AI prompt library versioned.
  - Builds ClickUp automations.
  - Tracks how often AI drafts are rejected.
  - Updates Cockpit field mappings when the Gateway changes.

- **Requirements:** L3 Senior Specialist I, or a strong L2 holding B2; A5 Innovation preferred; confident with ClickUp automations and spreadsheets; basic scripting is a plus.
- **KPIs:**
  - Bundle defect rate under 2%.
  - At least 80% of AI drafts accepted without major edits.
  - Mapping fixes within 1 business day.

Bridge night rota (Bundle QA)

Purpose: Nothing reaches the US desk unless it is ready to file. There are no bridge shift leads; the bridge night rota does Bundle QA.

- **Who:** any L2, L3 or L4 holding B2 can opt in. Each night has at least one A2 holder as night lead. The rota reports to the Onshore–Offshore Liaison portfolio owner, who sets it each quarter from the opt-ins.
- **Hours:** 16:00–24:00 Beirut, Monday to Friday (08:00–16:00 Central), 2 members a night.
- **Duties:**
  - Checks every bundle against the checklist before release.
  - Answers the US desk within 15 minutes.
  - Fixes rejected bundles the same US day.
  - Posts the nightly handover log.
- **KPIs:**
  - 98% of bundles right the first time.
  - US desk questions answered within 15 minutes.
  - No deadline missed because of a bundle.
- **Pay:** a $30,000 quarterly pool shared equally by the rota ($300–3,000 each, about $230 per night worked). Full share when the rota meets its targets and the member works all assigned nights; transport home after the shift.

Schedules

Work moves in one 24-hour loop. Lebanon releases bundles throughout the afternoon, the US files them from 7:00 to 19:00 Central, and results are waiting in ClickUp when Beirut starts the next morning.

Beirut	Central (US)	Lebanon	US desk
08:00	00:00	Teams start (08:00–16:30); review overnight determinations already logged by AI	—
12:00	04:00	Approved bundles released continuously	—
15:00	07:00	—	Specialist A starts (07:00–15:30)
16:00	08:00	Teams finish at 16:30; the bridge night rota starts (16:00–24:00) and checks every bundle before release	Lead starts (08:00–16:30)
18:00	10:00	**Last release for same-day filing**	Specialist B starts at 10:30 (10:30–19:00)
24:00	16:00	Bridge night rota posts the handover log and ends	Rejected bundles after this point are fixed the next Beirut morning
03:00	19:00	—	Queue cleared; determinations downloaded; AI logs them overnight

Coverage rules:

- At least 2 of the 3 US staff work every weekday.
- Leave is approved only while the backlog is under half a day.
- 2 pre-trained on-call staff, recruited in-house, cover sickness.

The offset is 8 hours for most of the year. Shift times move for the few weeks each spring and autumn when the two countries change their clocks on different dates.

Benefits

Model B keeps Model A's pay. The US desk gets a standard benefits package, and the bridge night rota shares a quarterly pool.

Element	Who	How it works	Guardrail
US package	US desk	Direct hire with health benefits, 15 days' paid leave, remote work on an existing company device	US-only devices and network; session recording on
Bridge night rota bonus	Bridge night rota (L2–L4 holding B2)	$30,000 a quarter shared equally by the rota ($300–3,000 each, about $230 per night worked); transport home after the shift	Full share only when rota targets are met and all assigned nights are worked; missed nights reduce the share pro rata

Tools and technology

The Submission Cockpit is the one new build, and we build it in-house on our existing Google Workspace, starting from the IDR Prep Studio. Everything else is configuration of tools and devices we already have. Model A's ClickUp ticket workflow and deadline engine stay underneath as the fallback.

Tool	What it does	Build or buy	Estimated cost (USD)	Ready by
Submission Cockpit	US-hosted web app with sign-on and MFA: bundle queue, a checklist for each Gateway action, a full audit log	Build in-house	Staff time; runs on existing systems	Feb 2027 pilot
Form filler	Browser extension on the US desk's company devices; the operator starts it and it fills the page from the bundle; never submits by itself	Built with the Cockpit	Included	Feb 2027, only if the Gateway's terms allow it

Tool	What it does	Build or buy	Estimated cost (USD)	Ready by
Bundle builder	ClickUp form for each action, plus automatic PDF assembly	Configure	Staff time	Jan 2027
AI drafting	Drafts packets, medical-necessity reports and offer letters for specialist approval	Buy (AI service covered by a BAA)	12,000–30,000 a year	Jan 2027
AI determination reader	Turns determination PDFs into ClickUp fields overnight	Build on the same AI service	Included	Mar 2027
US device security	Device management, screen recording and US-only network rules on existing company devices	Buy	Staff time	Dec 2026
Dashboards	Net Recovery, US queue	Configure (Looker Studio)	Low	Feb 2027

Cost: Model B against Model A

Model B has almost no up-front cost: the Cockpit is built in-house on existing systems, so its only one-time item beyond Model A's is the legal review. It saves $154,000–177,000 a year at today's volume once the desk steps down to 3 people, and the savings grow with volume. US figures are approximate Texas market rates for direct hires, plus about 25% benefits and payroll taxes, not quotes. Recruiting is in-house, and neither model carries infrastructure costs.

Annual cost (USD)	Model A	Model B	Model B saves	Model C (proposed)
US desk today	7 people, direct hire: 346,000–421,000	3 people, direct hire: 180,000–214,000		5 people, direct hire: 252,000–307,000
New technology, running costs	—	AI drafting service: 12,000–30,000		— (IDR Prep Studio runs on existing Google Workspace)
Today, total	346,000–421,000	192,000–244,000	154,000–177,000	252,000–307,000 (saves 94,000–114,000)
Year 1 (about 4,400 disputes a month)	12 people: 580,000–707,000	5 people + AI drafting: 302,000–374,000	278,000–333,000	8 people: 393,000–478,000 (saves 187,000–229,000)
Year 2 (about 6,500 disputes a month)	18 people: 861,000–1,050,000	7 people + AI drafting: 412,000–504,000	449,000–546,000	11 people: 533,000–650,000 (saves 328,000–400,000)
One-time	Paid onboarding, November–December: 58,000–70,000	The same onboarding, plus legal review of the Cockpit (quote needed)	—	The same onboarding only

Lebanon: AI drafting targets about 23 fewer hires by year two, worth roughly $380,000 a year.

Cost of the safety net: Model A's contract US desk runs January to March while the Cockpit is piloted. Under Model B that is about $87,000–105,000, which we spend anyway under Model A.

Rollout, gates and kill switches

Model B is earned in stages. Each gate must pass before the next step, and the January 1 deadline never depends on new software.

1. **October–December 2026: Model A, with an exit option.**
    - Hire the 7-person US desk in-house on 3–6 month contracts.
    - Get legal sign-off on the Cockpit and the Gateway terms check.
    - Start the Cockpit build and pick the Automation Cell.
    - **Gate 0, November 30:** legal and the Gateway terms both say yes. If not, Model B stops here and Model A continues.
2. **January 1, 2027: the Gateway goes US-only, on Model A's desk.**
3. **February–mid-March 2027: Cockpit pilot.**
    - Two contractors file 20%, then 50%, of volume through the Cockpit, timed side by side with manual entry.
    - **Gate 1, March 15:** 12 minutes or less per dispute, error rate under 0.5%, 98% of bundles right the first time, and no missed deadlines.
4. **March–April 2027: step down.**
    - Hire the 3 permanent US staff.
    - Let contracts end one at a time as the Cockpit's share reaches 100%.
    - **Gate 2, April 30:** 4 weeks on 3 people with the backlog under 1 business day.
5. **May 2027 onward: scale the bold parts.**
    - Switch on the AI determination reader.

Kill switches. We go back to Model A staffing if any of these happens:

- The backlog stays above 1 business day for 5 days in a row.
- The desk or a bundle causes a missed IDR deadline.
- The error rate stays above 1% for 2 weeks.
- The Gateway changes its terms or blocks the form filler.

The way back is ready at all times. In-house recruiting keeps a bench of pre-screened candidates so 4 trained people can start within 2 weeks, and Model A's manual ticket flow stays live so manual entry is always possible.

Risks

Model B swaps headcount risk for technology and concentration risk. The biggest single risk is that one absence leaves the desk a third short.

Risk	Likelihood	Impact	Response
Gateway terms forbid the form filler	Medium	High	Gate 0 checks first; fall back to copy assistance on screen and Model A staffing
One US absence cuts capacity by a third	High	High	2 trained on-call staff; leave rules; kill switch on backlog
A Gateway screen change breaks the Cockpit's field mapping	Medium	Medium	Analysts fix mappings within 1 day; manual entry always available
AI drafts contain errors	Medium	High	Every draft approved by a specialist; QA samples AI output weekly
A bundle defect spreads to many disputes	Low	High	The bridge night rota checks 100% of bundles; analysts fix the template, not just the case
The US team burns out at 40 disputes a shift	Medium	Medium	Remote work and a review of the pace at Gate 2